

Semiconductor/Tech Materials

Apr-Jun overseas results: Upward revisions of demand outlook; prices trending upward for SPE and materials

We summarize the key takeaways from the Apr-Jun overseas results: **(1) chipmaker capex trends, (2) SPE makers' WFE market and pricing outlooks, (3) InP substrate capacity, and (4) memory chip makers' LTAs.** In all cases, demand is even stronger than three months ago. With demand continuing to stay strong, not only memory chip makers but also SPE and material makers showed signs of gradual progress on raising prices. This development is also positive for the earnings outlooks of Japanese semiconductor and tech material companies.

Capex trends of chipmakers

The companies raised their capex plans because of strong demand. The investments are to be primarily for front-end equipment, but demand for back-end equipment also appears to be growing steadily.

1. **TSMC (2330 TW, Overweight, covered by Gokul Hariharan)** raised its CY2026 planned capex by about 15% from \$52-56 billion to \$60-64 billion (+52% YoY based on the midpoint). Advanced process technologies account for 70-80% of the capex. Management noted it is working closely with SPE makers and that SPE should not become a bottleneck.
2. **Intel (INTC, Underweight, covered by Harlan Sur)** also raised its CY2026 planned capex from flat YoY (around \$18 billion) to \$20 billion (+11% YoY), of which equipment capex is to increase 40% YoY, and expects a further significant increase YoY in CY2027. Management plans to allocate the majority of capex to the US. Most of the capex is to be allocated to front-end equipment, which costs relatively more, but management also plans to increase investments in back-end equipment related to EMIB-T. The 18A node, which is currently in risk production, is to transition to mass production by end-2026, while 14A is scheduled for risk production in 2H CY2027 and mass production in 2028.
3. **SK hynix (000660 KS, Overweight, covered by Jay Kwon)** announced CY2026 planned capex of KRW40 trillion (+45% YoY). Management stated it has brought forward the mass production ramp-up of M15X and will launch the Yongin Fab 1 cleanroom in early 2027. **Samsung Electronics (005930 KS, Overweight, covered by Jay Kwon)** did not mention its detailed plan, but for the foundry side, its Taylor Fab 1 is to start up in 2026 as planned and gradually ramp up 2nm process production. Management aims to start construction on Taylor Fab 2 this year and have it begin mass production in 2030.

SPE makers' trends (WFE market outlook, pricing trends)

The WFE market outlook has improved further compared with three months ago. **Tokyo Electron (8035, Overweight)** raised its WFE market outlook from \$150-170 billion for CY2026-27 (+20% or more vs CY2025) to \$150 billion or more for CY2026 and \$190 billion or more for CY2027, noting room for further upside. In addition, management noted the possibility of the gross margin reaching 50% (versus 47% in Apr-Jun 2026) early in FY2027 through price hikes and other measures. **SCREEN Holdings (7735, Overweight)** raised its outlook, primarily for memory chips, from around +15-20% YoY to over +20% YoY (at least \$140 billion) for CY2026 and expects similar growth for CY2027.

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1. **Lam Research (LRCX, Overweight, covered by Harlan Sur)** raised its CY2026 WFE market outlook from \$140 billion or more to the low-\$150 billion range, noting that the setup for CY2027 is very good. Management expects China's WFE market to be flat to slightly up YoY. It said the gross margin reached 52% in Apr-Jun (versus 50% in Jan-Mar) thanks to price hikes and other factors. Management aims for a 55% gross margin by continuing to offer high value-added products. It raised its estimate of WFE demand per \$100 billion of AI investments from about \$8 billion to \$9-10 billion, given the rise in the semiconductor share of AI infrastructure (details [here](#)).
2. **Applied Materials (AMAT, Overweight, covered by Harlan Sur)** did not mention a WFE market outlook, but has a perspective on five-year roadmaps from major customers. The information is even more detailed for the next eight quarters, indicating that visibility is even better than before. Management said that the gross margin has risen by about 300bps over the past three years, driven mainly by a successful value-based pricing strategy (reflecting cost increases in prices). The company-wide gross margin also exceeds 50%, while the semi systems segment's margin is over 55%.
3. **KLA (KLAC, Overweight, covered by Harlan Sur)** raised its CY2026 outlook from \$140 billion or more (about +25% YoY) to the low-\$150 billion range and noted the CY2027 figure could be \$190 billion with similar growth. Management expects margins, which have been affected by cost increases of over 100bps due to higher memory chip prices, to rise heading into 2027. For new products, management plans to raise prices by adding value, but it is not easy to raise prices for products for which the company has already won orders.

InP substrates

JX Advanced Metals (5016, Overweight, co-covered with Yasuhiro Nakada) plans to expand its InP substrate capacity by 7-10x by 2030 in anticipation of strong demand. Management plans to start by expanding capacity for 3-inch substrates and then expand 4- and 6-inch substrates.

1. At their Apr-Jun earnings briefings, **Lumentum (LITE, Overweight, covered by Joseph Cardoso)** and **Coherent (COHR, Overweight, covered by Joseph Cardoso)** both noted that demand is stronger than before. LITE mentioned that the current supply-demand gap is over 30%. COHR is shifting to 6-inch substrates to expand output. COHR management noted that compared with 3-inch substrates, it can quadruple the production volume at half the cost and still have high yields. With InP substrate supplies being the biggest constraint, both companies signed long-term agreements (LTA) with **AXT (AXTI, not covered)**.
2. **AXTI** aims to increase capacity by 3x YoY by end-2026 (to \$60 million in quarterly sales) and by over 2x YoY by end-2027 (to over \$130 million). Over 50% of its current sales are to China. Management expects the ratio to settle at around 40-60%. Demand is high, and 2027 demand is already covered. Visibility beyond that has improved through LTAs. Management noted it has also seen significant progress on developing 6-inch substrates, which involve high technical hurdles.

Memory chips (LTAs)

Memory chip stocks, including **Kioxia Holdings (285A, Overweight, co-covered with Jay Kwon)**, have corrected significantly since peaking in June. We think improved confidence in LTAs and shareholder payouts are key to their rerating ([reference](#)). While we think it will take some time for LTA credibility to improve, global memory chip makers are gradually providing details of the arrangements.

1. **Samsung Electronics** has already finalized five LTAs with data center customers and is in the final stages of negotiations on five more. It plans to use rolling contracts based on

requests for five-year terms and expects to receive substantial prepayments.

2. **SK hynix** has already signed 10 contracts, which appear to be based on five-year terms with prepayments. Prices vary by customer, but management aims to use the contracts to reduce price volatility.
3. **SanDisk (SNDK, Overweight, covered by Harlan Sur)** has already signed eight contracts (three of which are with US hyperscalers) with an average term of four years (maximum five years), but noted that it has received inquiries from multiple customers about contracts extending beyond five years. The contracts are generally based on prepayments and cover 50% of bit demand in FY2027 and about two-thirds in FY2028. Pricing is fixed or variable, depending on the customer, but management noted the gross margin can be about 80% even based on the floor price of a variable pricing structure (which includes ceiling and floor prices).

Figure 1: Valuation of companies under coverage

		Rating	Share price (LC)	Price target (LC)	Date (ddmmyy)	Market cap (¥bn)	Market cap (\$mn)	Sales 3FY E (%) CAGR	EPS 3FY E (%) CAGR	PER (x)			EBITDA 3FY E (%) CAGR	EV/EBITDA (x)		PBR (x)		ROE (%)		Div. yield (%)		FCF yield (%)		OPM (%)		
										1FY E	2FY E	3FY E		1FY E	2FY E	1FY E	2FY E	1FY E	2FY E	1FY E	2FY E	1FY E	2FY E	1FY E	2FY E	
Technical Materials																										
JX ADVANCED META	5016	¥	OW	3,785	4,800	14-Aug-26	3,593	22,543	9.4	26.7	21.3	19.3	16.5	50.0	13.0	12.3	4.5	3.7	20.6	21.0	0.9	1.2	1.9	2.5	24.5	25.1
AGC INC	5201	¥	N	5,961	7,500	14-Aug-26	1,296	8,133	4.6	18.5	15.0	12.6	11.0	9.6	5.8	5.0	0.8	0.8	5.8	6.5	3.5	3.7	18.1	20.1	6.9	7.7
NITTO BOSEKI CO	3110	¥	OW	3,165	5,800	14-Aug-26	597	3,746	16.0	-5.3	29.1	21.4	16.2	33.1	16.0	12.3	3.1	2.8	11.2	14.0	1.0	1.3	-4.3	-0.4	20.5	23.7
NIPPON ELEC GLS	5214	¥	OW	5,145	7,300	14-Aug-26	461	2,890	2.5	1.6	17.0	14.5	12.8	3.3	8.2	7.9	0.8	0.8	4.7	4.9	3.1	3.2	2.3	3.9	9.0	10.8
NIPPON SHEET GLA	5202	¥	N	483	500	14-Aug-26	69	431	3.5	-3.5	45.8	16.4	12.1	6.8	7.0	6.3	0.6	0.6	1.0	2.8	2.8	2.8	24.6	13.6	3.4	4.3
TAIHEIYO CEMENT	5233	¥	OW	4,228	5,000	14-Aug-26	500	3,136	8.1	40.2	9.1	7.6	6.7	9.0	6.8	5.8	0.7	0.6	7.6	8.1	2.8	3.0	-19.4	3.8	7.3	8.5
SUMITOMO OSAKA	5232	¥	OW	5,912	6,500	14-Aug-26	190	1,190	6.2	24.3	18.2	11.3	8.8	16.5	6.6	5.2	0.9	0.9	5.2	8.4	2.0	2.2	4.3	4.7	6.3	9.0
KANEKA CORP	4118	¥	N	6,345	4,600	14-Aug-26	400	2,508	3.7	3.3	12.9	12.6	11.5	7.3	6.9	6.6	0.7	0.7	5.8	5.4	3.2	3.6	3.0	1.5	4.4	4.8
Average									6.7	13.2	21.1	14.4	12.0	17.0	8.8	7.7	1.5	1.3	7.7	8.9	2.4	2.7	3.8	6.2	10.3	11.7
Japanese semiconductor related																										
KIOXIA HOLDINGS	285A	¥	OW	53,740	130,000	14-Aug-26	29,450	184,792	83.3	142.8	5.3	4.1	3.7	116.0	3.2	2.0	4.6	2.4	139.4	82.9	1.7	5.1	15.9	24.3	79.0	80.5
TOKYO ELECTRON	8035	¥	OW	59,130	85,000	14-Aug-26	27,675	173,651	25.4	30.7	35.9	26.2	21.1	34.6	25.4	18.7	11.3	9.3	34.4	40.0	1.4	1.9	1.2	2.6	29.4	32.4
ADVANTEST CORP	6857	¥	OW	36,870	41,000	14-Aug-26	26,989	169,347	28.7	35.2	42.6	34.5	29.0	33.8	30.6	24.1	21.9	15.2	59.6	53.1	0.3	0.5	1.8	2.5	49.4	50.4
HOYA CORP	7741	¥	OW	26,645	31,000	14-Aug-26	8,922	55,981	8.2	11.4	32.4	29.0	25.9	9.8	21.1	19.1	8.7	8.2	26.4	29.1	1.2	1.4	2.6	2.8	32.5	33.9
DISCO CORP	6146	¥	N	65,470	83,000	14-Aug-26	7,103	44,567	19.3	24.9	38.3	31.2	26.9	22.2	25.4	20.8	10.1	8.4	28.3	27.8	1.0	1.2	1.9	2.5	45.5	47.2
LASERTEC CORP	6920	¥	N	38,820	54,000	14-Aug-26	3,660	22,967	25.6	28.1	34.8	26.1	21.4	26.8	24.6	18.9	11.0	8.6	35.2	35.3	1.0	1.3	2.0	2.6	47.1	48.6
SCREEN HOLDINGS	7735	¥	OW	14,275	18,000	14-Aug-26	2,723	17,087	17.7	23.9	23.0	17.9	15.4	21.5	14.4	11.5	4.9	4.2	22.1	23.9	1.3	1.6	1.9	3.5	21.3	23.1
NIKON CORP	7731	¥	OW	2,046	1,300	14-Aug-26	682	4,282	4.6	--	67.8	31.8	22.6	--	14.3	11.6	1.2	1.1	2.3	3.8	1.0	1.5	-2.7	--	1.3	3.1
RIGAKU HOLDINGS	268A	¥	OW	2,087	3,100	14-Aug-26	473	2,966	10.3	20.0	34.5	27.6	24.1	15.8	19.8	16.1	4.9	4.4	14.8	16.2	0.9	1.1	2.1	2.0	19.2	21.2
ULVAC INC	6728	¥	OW	9,370	10,000	14-Aug-26	462	2,902	3.6	16.7	20.3	17.3	17.0	18.6	9.0	7.6	1.8	1.7	9.7	10.7	1.8	2.1	4.7	4.7	12.0	13.5
Average									15.9	23.9	36.6	26.8	22.6	22.9	20.5	16.5	8.4	6.8	25.9	26.7	1.1	1.4	1.7	2.9	28.6	30.4

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. consensus estimates, J.P. Morgan.
Note: All Bloomberg consensus estimates.

Figure 2: Performance of companies under coverage

	Rating	Price 14-Aug-26 (JPY)	Market cap 14-Aug-26 (mn JPY)	Trading volume 30days moving ave. (k shares)	Trading value 30days moving ave. (mn JPY)	1M Actual performance (%)	3M Actual performance (%)	6M Actual performance (%)	1Y Actual performance (%)	1M Relative performance vs Topix (%)	3M Relative performance vs Topix (%)	6M Relative performance vs Topix (%)	1Y Relative performance vs Topix (%)	β Topix
Technical Materials														
3110 Nittobo	OW	3,165	596,967	6,329	20,353	4.3	-33.8	-25.9	166.9	-2.6	-39.0	-33.6	97.6	1.85
4118 Kaneka	N	6,345	399,735	250	1,328	13.5	18.5	27.3	47.5	6.0	9.1	14.0	9.2	0.84
5016 JX Advanced Metals	OW	3,785	3,592,658	22,228	86,790	6.4	-9.3	17.0	249.2	-0.7	-16.5	4.8	158.5	1.92
5201 AGC	N	5,961	1,296,128	1,516	9,259	-2.8	-0.6	-6.4	30.1	-9.3	-8.5	-16.1	-3.7	1.22
5202 Nippon Sheet Glass	N	483	68,750	895	454	0.4	0.4	-19.9	-10.7	-6.2	-7.6	-28.2	-33.9	0.87
5214 Nippon Electric Glass	OW	5,145	460,597	724	3,905	-7.7	-26.5	-10.3	21.3	-13.8	-32.4	-19.6	-10.2	1.31
5232 Sumitomo Osaka Cement	OW	5,912	189,587	338	1,905	10.2	20.7	38.2	50.4	2.9	11.1	23.9	11.4	1.22
5233 Taiheiyō Cement	OW	4,228	499,714	592	2,457	7.8	6.6	-10.2	7.3	0.7	-1.9	-19.5	-20.5	1.13
Semiconductor/SPE														
268A Rigaku HD	OW	2,087	472,739	2,886	6,512	-7.9	-26.9	61.8	155.4	-14.0	-32.7	45.0	89.1	1.56
285A Kioxia HD	OW	53,740	29,450,331	47,270	2,801,313	3.1	20.9	140.2	1,999.2	-3.7	11.3	115.3	1,454.3	2.33
6146 Disco	N	65,470	7,102,624	1,881	123,226	1.1	0.9	-8.7	54.6	-5.6	-7.1	-18.2	14.5	1.67
6728 Ulvac	OW	9,370	462,465	545	5,092	-1.4	-1.2	-7.0	51.8	-7.9	-9.1	-16.6	12.4	1.50
6857 Advantest	OW	36,870	26,988,840	9,461	280,350	34.0	39.9	37.6	226.4	25.2	28.8	23.3	141.7	1.77
6920 Lasertec	N	38,820	3,660,198	3,624	154,106	-7.3	1.1	26.8	123.0	-13.5	-7.0	13.6	65.1	1.69
7731 Nikon	OW	2,046	682,350	1,824	3,845	-7.0	-9.7	5.4	45.3	-13.1	-16.9	-5.6	7.6	0.99
7735 SCREEN HD	OW	14,275	2,723,099	3,785	60,303	-13.5	25.9	34.5	147.1	-19.3	15.9	20.6	82.9	1.59
7741 HOYA	OW	26,645	8,921,759	1,061	26,872	5.7	-4.9	-2.8	37.5	-1.3	-12.4	-12.9	1.8	0.80
8035 Tokyo Electron	OW	59,130	27,674,774	4,363	282,046	-9.2	17.6	40.3	175.0	-15.2	8.2	25.7	103.6	1.51
Performance weighted average						6.7	18.6	55.9	630.0	-0.4	9.2	39.7	440.5	
Performance single average						1.7	2.2	18.8	198.7	-5.1	-5.9	6.4	121.2	
Topix		4,197		2,794,846		7.1	8.6	11.6	35.1					

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 14 August 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
JX Advanced Metals (5016)(5016.T/¥3,785/OW), KIOXIA Holdings (285A)(285A.T/¥53,740/OW), SCREEN Holdings (7735)
(7735.T/¥14,275/OW), Tokyo Electron (8035)(8035.T/¥59,130/OW)

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JX Advanced Metals (5016) (5016.T, 5016 JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
21-Apr-25	N	840	850
12-Nov-25	N	1960	1,900
04-Feb-26	N	2480	2,500
20-Mar-26	N	3788	3,700
11-May-26	NR	5416	--
18-Jun-26	OW	4366	5,700
17-Aug-26	OW	3785	4,800

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 21, 2025. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

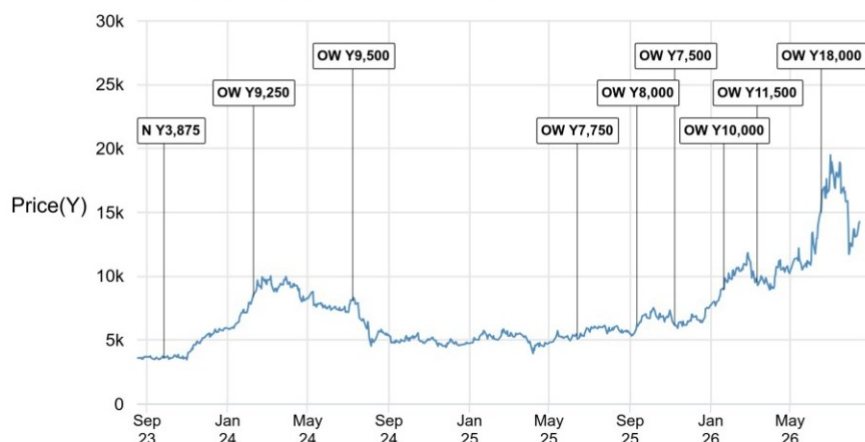
KIOXIA Holdings (285A) (285A.T, 285A JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
23-Jan-26	OW	17910	25,000
22-Mar-26	OW	22360	38,000
17-May-26	OW	44450	80,000
19-Jun-26	OW	96900	155,000
10-Aug-26	OW	47730	130,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jan 23, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

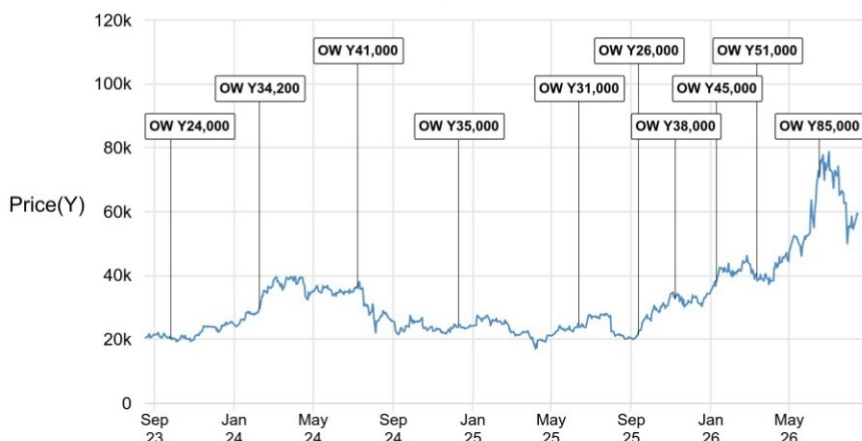
SCREEN Holdings (7735) (7735.T, 7735 JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
27-Sep-23	N	3608	3,875
09-Feb-24	OW	8385	9,250
09-Jul-24	OW	8105	9,500
13-Jun-25	OW	5345	7,750
12-Sep-25	OW	6222	8,000
08-Nov-25	OW	6175	7,500
21-Jan-26	OW	8962	10,000
13-Mar-26	OW	9548	11,500
17-Jun-26	OW	14970	18,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Mar 28, 2004. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Tokyo Electron (8035) (8035.T, 8035 JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
27-Sep-23	OW	20165	24,000
09-Feb-24	OW	29435	34,200
09-Jul-24	OW	36040	41,000
11-Dec-24	OW	24600	35,000
13-Jun-25	OW	25000	31,000
12-Sep-25	OW	21405	26,000
08-Nov-25	OW	32800	38,000
10-Jan-26	OW	37910	45,000
13-Mar-26	OW	39750	51,000
17-Jun-26	OW	70860	85,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 04, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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